



A Beginner's Guide to Golf in Mallorca

Where to start, what it costs, what to bring and what really happens on the day, from a PGA professional.

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PALMA PITCH & PUTT



GOLF POLLENCA



SON QUINT



SON ANTEM EAST



SANTA PONSA 3

FIVE COURSES TO START ON

COURSE	HOLES / PAR	PEAK FEE	DIFFICULTY	WHY IT WORKS
Palma Pitch & Putt	9H / 27	€22	2/10	All par 3s, no pressure, 2 min from Palma
Golf Pollenca	9H / 35	€65	4/10	Short, scenic, relaxed nine holes
Golf Son Quint	18H / 71	€140	5/10	Wide fairways, four tee positions
Golf Son Antem East	18H / 72	€140	6/10	Generous and forgiving resort course
Golf Santa Ponsa 3	9H / 30	€30	4/10	Short holes, great for approach play

Start with the nine-holers. They are shorter, cheaper and far less daunting than a full eighteen. Santa Ponsa 3 is members and guests only, so play it with a member or ask me to arrange access.

WHAT IT COSTS TO BEGIN

GREEN FEE

€22+

A nine-hole round starts around €22. Eighteen holes at a beginner-friendly course runs €65 to €140.

CLUB HIRE

€25-45

Per round. You do not need your own clubs to start. Pre-book a set in peak season.

COACHING

On Course

I coach out on the course, even over nine holes, where you learn in real situations rather than on a range.

WHAT TO BRING

Clubs and balls. You do not need your own set to start: hire one at the course for €25 to €45, or bring your own if you have them. Carry three to five balls because you will lose a few early on, and that is completely normal. Used balls are fine while you are learning.

The dress code. A collared shirt is required at almost every course in Mallorca. Tailored shorts or trousers are both fine. Metal spikes are banned, so wear soft-spiked golf shoes or flat trainers if that is all you have.

For the sun and the round. Bring sunscreen, a hat, plenty of water and a light layer for early starts. The Mallorca sun is strong from March to October and a full round takes several hours, so pace yourself and stay hydrated.

WHAT ACTUALLY HAPPENS ON THE DAY

Booking. Call the course one to two days ahead, or ask me to arrange it. Most beginner-friendly courses have no handicap requirement, but it is worth checking when you book so there are no surprises at the first tee.

Arriving. Get there 20 to 30 minutes before your tee time. Check in at the pro shop, pay any balance, collect a buggy or trolley and hit a few balls on the range if there is one. Tee times are taken seriously here, so do not be late.

Pace and etiquette. Nine holes take around 1.5 to 2 hours, eighteen closer to four. The main rule is simple: keep up with the group ahead, and wave faster players through if you fall behind. Do not worry about your score on the first round, just enjoy being out there.

Walk or ride. Walking is free at most courses and the best way to learn a layout. If you would rather save your legs, a buggy is €30 to €50 and an electric trolley a cheaper €15 to €20.



WHEN TO COME

November to March is cooler, quieter and 40 to 50 percent cheaper on green fees. Spring and autumn give you the best balance of weather and value. High summer is hot, so play early in the morning and rest through the afternoon.

COMMON FIRST-TIMER QUESTIONS

Do I need a handicap? Not for any of the five courses above. A handicap certificate is only asked for at a few championship courses like Son Gual and Golf de Andratx, which are not where you should be starting anyway.

Is it rude to be slow? No one minds a beginner playing carefully. What matters is keeping pace with the group in front, not your score. If a faster group catches you, wave them through and carry on at your own speed.

What if I can only play a few holes? That is exactly what the nine-holes are for. Palma Pitch & Putt or Pollenca are perfect for an hour or two, and an on-course session with a coach over nine holes will teach you more than a bucket of range balls.

YOUR FIRST ROUND, MADE EASY

I work with new golfers in Mallorca through on-course coaching, even over nine holes, and can match the course and tee time to where you are starting from, or recommend the right local coach. Email andy@mrmallorcagolf.com and tell me you are just beginning.